

- ▶ **Platform constraints:** What platform are you targeting? What is its reach? What is the target audience for the game? Do they have access to this platform?
- ▶ **Ethical constraints:** What is the desired rating for the game? (Although the game won't be rated by the ESRB (Entertainment Software Rating Board) until it's nearly finished production, if at all, publishers have an ideal rating in mind and strive to develop a game to fit that rating.)
- ▶ **Publishing constraints:** Does the publisher have any particular genre or category of game in mind? Are there any features that the publisher would like to see in the game? All these constraints play a major role as they might even end up in changing your core-game mechanic.

Writing game design documents

Writing documents is an integral part of a Game Designer's job. Hence, designers produce a series of documents to tell others about their game design. Design documents are very important, as they are used to communicate the ideas properly to artists and programmers with a clarity and certainty.

There are different types of documents produced for different purposes. Let's have an overview at all of them:

High-concept Document

As the name goes, it is not a detailed document from which the complete game can be built. The purpose of a high concept document is to promote and present the game idea before publishers and producers. High-concept doc puts the key ideas of a game on paper so that it can be read in a few minutes and an overview of a game can be understood.

A high-concept document also contains some additional details such as game competition, the unique selling points (USP) that make your game stand out in the marketplace, and possible marketing strategies and related merchandising opportunities.

Game treatment / concept document

This document, very similar to the High-Concept document presents the game in a broad-outline. But this document is presented to someone who is already interested in it and wants to know more details about it. This document is almost like a brochure that sums up the basic idea of the game.